



Technology Innovation HUB Workshop - LA

For the **National Football League**

Thursday, October 26, 2023

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N-Ovate Solutions





LA Workshop Agenda

1

GOALS & OBJECTIVES

Defining and aligning on goals, and setting the innovation path.

3

GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

Establishing the framework for decision-making and oversight.

2

ZONE-TO-WIN FRAMEWORK

Strategically navigating current performance and future innovations.

4

ZONE MAPPING & POC's

Aligning innovations with goals and testing viability.



Goals & Objectives

Our goals encompass strategic alignment, consistency, accountability, and repeatability within the NFL's Innovation Hub. We're guided by our N-Ovate Innovation Nexus (NIN), **a disruptive framework that accelerates innovation**, enabling us to stay ahead in a rapidly changing landscape.



Mission & Goals

1. Strategic Alignment

Align the NFL's portfolio of innovation investments with its critical business outcomes

2. Consistency

Provide a consistent, enterprise-wide approach to identify, prioritize, measure, & successfully deliver major innovation initiatives and projects

3. Accountability

Utilize venture investment metrics to measure innovation project performance & delivery timetable

4. Repeatability

Create a standardized and repeatable demand management, capacity planning & project prioritization management framework, vocabulary, & toolset



“**N-Ovate is dedicated to pioneering innovation.** Our mission with the NFL's Innovation Hub is to reimagine every aspect of NFL operations, harnessing technology and fostering limitless innovation.”



Introducing the N-Ovate Innovation Nexus [NIN]

→ What is NIN?

N-Ovate Innovation Nexus™ [NIN] is a delivery model that seamlessly intertwines governance principles with innovative strategies. It is purposefully designed as a disruptive innovation platform.

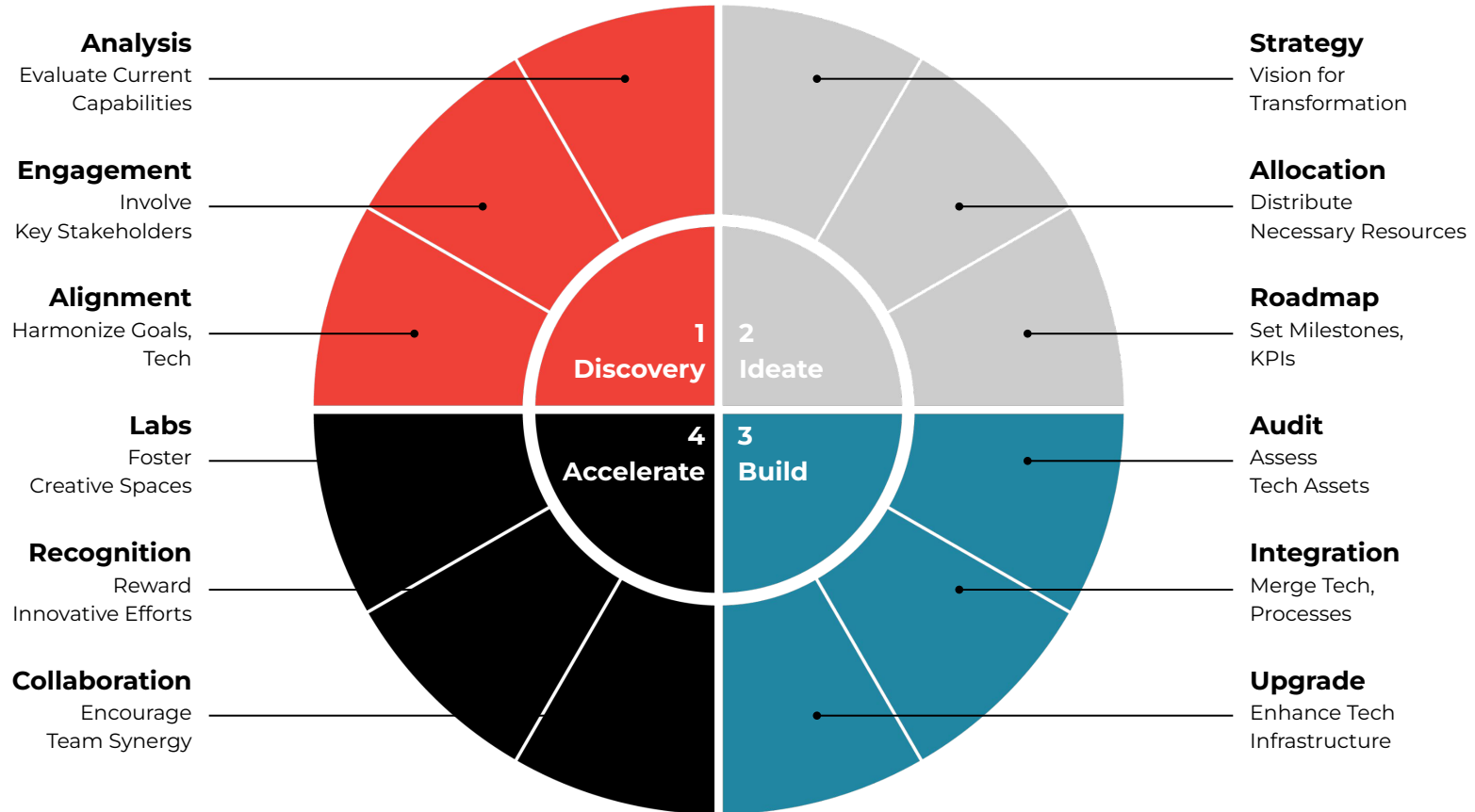
→ Why NIN?

NIN isn't just a platform; it's the pivotal junction of numerous celebrated innovation frameworks. It stands out with its unparalleled speed in delivering tailor-made solutions designed to navigate your organization through its unique innovation journey.

For this project, NIN has effectively harnessed and integrated the **Zone-to-Win innovation framework**, enhancing its ability to identify winning opportunities and swiftly transform them into actionable strategies for the NFL's Innovation Hub.



The NIN Methodology



Introducing Zone-to-Win

N-Ovate selected the "Zone-to-Win" framework for the NFL Innovation Hub **to strategically navigate present performance and future disruptive innovations.** We've introduced this framework to ensure the NFL Hub remains aligned with organizational goals and future-centric visions.

Introducing Zone-to-Win

The Zone-to-Win framework delineates **Performance, Productivity, Incubation, and Transformation**. **It's our strategy compass, ensuring we stay on the right innovation track.**

- **Framework Overview**

The "Zone to Win" concept for guiding organizational innovation.

- **Holistic Organizational View**

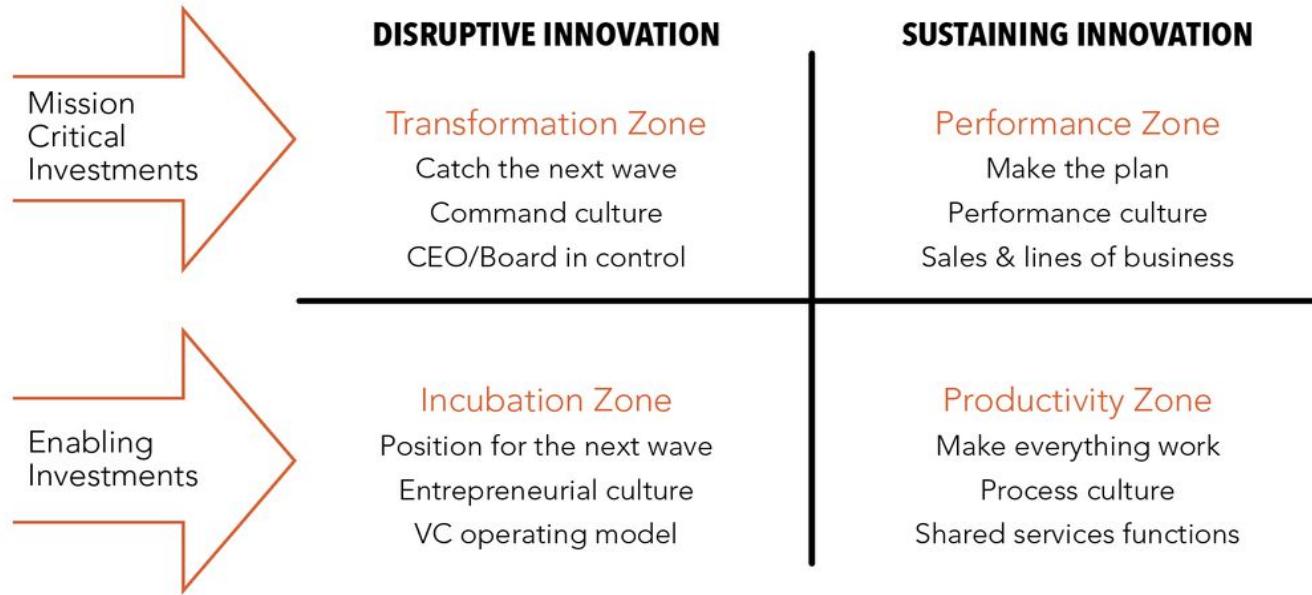
Encouraging attendees to think beyond individual roles and align with organizational goals.

- **Sustaining vs. Disruptive**

The duality of current performance-focused innovations vs. future-centric disruptive innovations.



The Zone-to-Win Framework



Sustaining Innovations: Today's Reality

→ **Performance Zone**

Utilize existing systems of intelligence to gain a deep understanding and deliver innovative value, all driven by your key performance indicators (KPIs).

→ **Productivity Zone**

Collaborate to maximize efficiency, share services, and magnify our impact. This involves streamlining, upgrading, or retiring old systems to unlock hidden potential.



Disruptive Innovations: Shaping the Future

→ **Incubation Zone**

Early-stage ideas are poised to bring significant opportunities—envisioning game-changers for the organization.

→ **Transformation Zone**

Scaling innovations to reshape the organization's core. Fosters new lines of business and organizational structures.

Innovation Challenge

Emphasis on transitioning from sustaining to disruptive innovations. Encouraging attendees to envision the future of the organization.



Strategic Planning Focus

League Goals: Increase Consumption & Fan Growth. Grow Key Demographics

Focus Areas

Direct-to-Consumer



International



Legalized Sports Betting



Non-Game, Media, & Content



Technology



Foundational Investments

Game



BUILDING A BETTER GAME

Fan Development



Business Operations



*League goals in no particular order

2023 NFL Key Risk Assessment

Top 15 NFL Risks

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|--|
| 1. Player Health & Safety | 9. International Markets |
| 2. Game Integrity | 10. Natural Disaster/
Unforeseen Event |
| 3. Game Quality | 11. Talent Management
(Diversity /
Succession) |
| 4. Reputation / Brand | 12. League-Club Support |
| 5. Fan Engagement | 13. Third-Party
Management |
| 6. Cyber-Security / Data
Privacy | 14. Event Management |
| 7. Youth Markets /
Football | 15. Economy /
Geo-Politics |
| 8. Legalized
Sports-Betting | |

“Next 5”

1. Media Fragmentation/Behavioral Shift
2. NFLPA Relations
3. Collective Bargaining
4. Internal Communications
5. Regulatory Compliance



HUB Governance Structure

EXECUTIVE STEERING COMMITTEE

STEERING COMMITTEE

Information Technology, Player Health and Safety, Football Operations, NFL Media, Data & Analytics, Finance, & Sponsorship

WORKING GROUP

- IT
- ISO
- Broadcast
- Player Health and Safety
- Football Tech
- NGS
- Digital Media
- Football Business Strategy & Ops

PHASE I PROJECTS

- Optical Tracking
- NFL View
- Natural Language Processing, Media Indexing



Governance Structure Overview

Objective: Establish a rapid-launch structure, inspired by Silicon Valley accelerator programs, tailored to fit the NFL's unique ecosystem.

Steering Committee as a Deciding Board

- Acts as the primary governing body for the innovation hub.
- Drives the rapid MVP model for funding and execution.
- Oversight on all innovation hub functions and decisions.

Proposed Funding Model

- Steering Committee plays a pivotal role in decision-making.
- Integration of sponsorship dollars for funding.
- Partners may allocate a portion of their contribution towards the HUB.



Proposal for Tech Advisory Innovation Council

Goal: Create a think tank comprising industry experts, innovators, and potentially representatives from tech companies that already partner with the league.

✓ Objectives

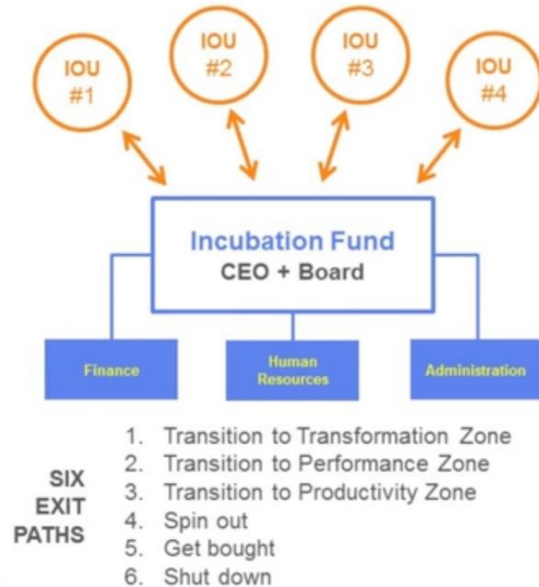
- Provides advisory and coaching roles similar to startup mentors.
- Facilitates fast-tracking of tech ideas, innovations, and potential applications to the league.

✓ Benefits

- Streamlined decision-making with the existing governing structure.
- Greater engagement from tech partners creates a win-win scenario for both the league and the partners.
- Establishes an ecosystem for innovative solutions, fostering a culture of continuous adaptation and growth.



Adopting the Startup-VC Model



Venture Capital (VC) models, especially Silicon Valley ones, are built on **rapid iteration, validation, and scale**.

The Key Models relevant for the HUB include:

1. MVP Development
2. Staged Funding
3. Feedback Loops



Evaluation Criteria

Objective: To develop an **Evaluation Framework for the NFL Technology Innovation Hub**, outlining the structure, strategy, and criteria governing the advancement of innovation projects within the NFL.

The NFL Technology Innovation HUB

The NFL Tech Innovation HUB is instrumental in the NFL's innovation journey.

It serves as the birthplace of ideas and as the **critical filter**, ensuring only the most aligned projects move forward.

- ✓ **Purpose.** Starting point for all innovation projects.
- ✓ **Outcome.** Projects advance **based on alignment, merit, and impact** potential or are discontinued unless viable.
- ✓ **KPI.** Number of projects initiated vs. progressed.



Decision Criteria for Zone Progression

The criteria ensures that every innovation project is strategically aligned with the NFL's overarching objectives.

- ✓ **Alignment with Business Needs**

Does the innovation sync with business performance areas such as revenue drivers and fan engagement?

- ✓ **Operational Impact**

Projects that streamline departments like marketing or finance typically move to the Productivity Zone.

- ✓ **Transformational Impact**

Game-changing innovations leading to significant league alterations are transitioned to the Transformation Zone.



Zone Outcomes & KPIs

✓ Incubation Zone

Outcome: Lay the foundation for projects, developing MVPs or initial stages.

KPI: Rate of project continuation post-incubation.

✓ Productivity Zone

Outcome: Enhance operational departments for further development.

KPI: Operational efficiency improvements (%).

✓ Transformation Zone

Outcome: Intensive development of impactful league projects.

KPI: Achievement of intended transformative impact metrics.

✓ Performance Zone

Outcome: Projects that amplify core league aspects.

KPI: Yearly targets met and revenue generation.



Funding & Project Continuation

Funding Importance

Different zones require distinct financial support levels.

Continuation and Progression

Projects' progression relies on their alignment with NFL's goals, their established viability, and the availability of funds

Funding Sources

- **Internal Budgeting:** Mainly for projects directly aligning with key league initiatives.
- **Sponsorships/Partnerships:** Harnessing NFL's partnerships, especially in tech, to sponsor innovations.
- **External Investments:** Engaging investors interested in the NFL's groundbreaking innovations.



The Road Ahead

The journey ahead is charted with clear milestones. Each step we take, each project we initiate, is a stride towards actualizing the NFL's vision for the future.

Introduction to the POC Working Group

Objective: We are developing a crucial Proof of Concept (POC) for our innovative intervention program. *Expect a detailed working group schedule soon.*

Working Group Composition: This group primary role will be to discuss, finalize, or be updated on the program's development.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| → Football Tech | → IT |
| → NGS | → ISO |
| → Digital Media | → Broadcast |
| → Football Business Strategy & Ops | → Player Health & Safety |



Simulation of Process with Three Projects

Three projects have been selected to model and simulate the intervention process. These projects will be taken through a simulated process, ensuring that the group understands each step's dynamics and implications.

1

Optical Tracking. Revolutionize real-time tracking, ensuring precision and accuracy in diverse applications.

2

NFL View. Bring fans closer to the action and providing unparalleled insights into the game

3

Natural Language Processing & Media Indexing. This project leverages cutting-edge NLP techniques to index, categorize, and retrieve media content with ease and efficiency



Rigorous Project Review & Value Demonstration

All projects [including the one being presented] will undergo a thorough review process.

- ✓ The selected projects will receive assistance in developing materials for their pitch, defining use cases, and more.
- ✓ Engaging in this process not only elevates the projects but **provides a cross-functional view** of what's available, enabling rich dialogue with league leaders.
- ✓ Leaders will challenge teams to **demonstrate the value** of their projects, determining whether to continue investment.



NLP & Media Indexing

Venturing into the intricate intersection of linguistics and media, this project employs avant-garde NLP methodologies. ***Its aim?*** To adeptly index, categorize, and retrieve media content. Let's delve into a discussion.

Questions & Insights

It's time for 'Open Discussion'. **This is your arena now.** Share your insights, pose questions, and let's collaboratively shape the NFL's innovative future.



Thank you.

